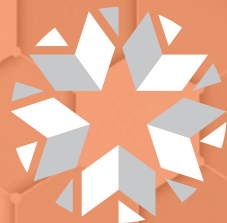


OKLAHOMA SCHOOL TESTING PROGRAM

TEST BLUEPRINT AND ITEM SPECIFICATIONS

GRADE 4 ENGLISH LANGUAGE ARTS



OKLAHOMA
Education

Read this passage. Then answer the questions that follow.

Why Do We Dream?

- 1 You are flying through the clouds. Down below, the earth looks like a patchwork quilt. Suddenly, an eagle flies up beside you. The beautiful bird reaches out and shakes your arm. "Wake up, sleepyhead," says your mom. "Time for school." You open your eyes. You are back in your own bedroom. Your flight in the clouds was just a dream.
- 2 Why do people dream? Scientists have been trying to answer that question for hundreds of years. They have developed many theories to explain our nightly adventures.

Boost Our Health and Skills

- 3 Some scientists believe that dreaming improves our health. The dreams give us a safe way to handle the events of our day. Our mind calmly sorts through these events while we sleep.
- 4 Have you ever dreamed about something you were learning to do, like playing the trumpet? Your dreams may have helped you master the skill. One study showed that people learning new activities dreamed much more often. Scientists think that their brains were trying to quickly memorize and organize this new information. Other research has shown that dreaming about physical skills, like playing basketball, improves a person's performance.

Solve Problems

- 5 Dreams may also help people solve problems. Deirdre Barrett of the Harvard Medical School studied this idea. She asked her students to think about a problem they had before going to sleep. What happened? Two-thirds of the students dreamed about their problems. About a third of the students dreamed of solutions for their problems.

Get Creative

- 6 Some famous people have even used their dreams in creative ways. A scientist named Kekule dreamed of snakes spinning in circles with their tails in their mouths. Kekule's dream helped him discover the shape of a molecule. Many authors, painters, and musicians have been inspired by dreams too. Mary Shelley got the idea for her book *Frankenstein* from a dream. That must have been one scary nightmare!

Make Your Dreams Work for You

- 7 Would you like your dreams to work for you? You can start by keeping a dream journal. Leave a notebook next to your bed. When you wake up in the morning, write down the dreams you remember. Maybe they will help you write a bestseller or paint a masterpiece!



1 Which sentence from the passage best supports the idea that sleep is important to learning?

- A** Scientists have been trying to answer that question for hundreds of years.
- B** The dreams give us a safe way to handle the events of our day.
- C** Scientists think that their brains were trying to quickly memorize and organize this new information.
- D** She asked her students to think about a problem they had before going to sleep.

Standard 2: Students will read and comprehend inclusive, diverse, and increasingly complex literary and informational texts.

4.2.R.1: Students will determine the key details that support the main idea of a text.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student must have a strong understanding of the text, paragraph 4 in particular, which allows him or her to evaluate specific statements in relation to an important idea and determine which of those statements best supports that idea.

Distractor Rationale

- A. This sentence is too vague to support the idea that sleep is important to learning.
- B. This sentence does not address the idea that sleep is important to learning, but addresses how dreams help us to cope with events of our day.
- C. Correct. This sentence supports the idea that sleep is important to learning by discussing how our brains are able to memorize and organize new information.**
- D. This sentence does not support the idea that sleep is important to learning.

2 A reader can tell that this passage is nonfiction because it

- A** explains something with factual information.
- B** is written with very short sentences.
- C** has words spoken by a character.
- D** is divided into several sections.

Standard 2: Students will read and comprehend inclusive, diverse, and increasingly complex literary and informational texts.

4.2.R.2: Students will compare fiction, poetry, and nonfiction to distinguish various genres.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student must go beyond recalling the elements of nonfiction and apply that knowledge to a specific text to determine why the passage fits the nonfiction classification.

Distractor Rationale

- A. Correct. This passage relates factual information, a prominent feature of nonfiction text, about why we dream.**
- B. The length of the sentences is unrelated to whether or not the passage is nonfiction.
- C. Nonfiction passages generally do not have characters. Characters are common feature of fiction.
- D. Both fiction and nonfiction passages can be divided into several sections, so this is not a discerning feature.

3 Which sentence from “Why Do We Dream?” contains a simile?

- A** You are flying through the clouds.
- B** Down below, the earth looks like a patchwork quilt.
- C** The beautiful bird reaches out and shakes your arm.
- D** You are back in your own bedroom.

Standard 3: Students will analyze, interpret, and evaluate increasingly complex literary and informational texts that include a wide range of historical, cultural, ethnic, and global perspectives from a variety of genres.

4.3.R.4: Students will find textual evidence of literary devices:

- metaphor
- idiom
- personification
- hyperbole
- simile
- alliteration
- onomatopoeia

Depth-of-Knowledge: 1

This item is a DOK 1 because it simply requires the student to recognize a simile.

Distractor Rationale

- A. A simile is a comparison between two things. Nothing is being compared in this sentence.
- B. Correct. The way the earth looks from a cloud is being compared to a patchwork quilt.**
- C. A simile is a comparison between two things. Nothing is being compared in this sentence.
- D. A simile is a comparison between two things. Nothing is being compared in this sentence.

4 Which statement in the article is an opinion?

- A** Scientists have been trying to answer that question for hundreds of years.
- B** One study showed that people learning new activities dreamed much more often.
- C** Two-thirds of the students dreamed about their problems.
- D** That must have been one scary nightmare!

Standard 3: Students will analyze, interpret, and evaluate increasingly complex literary and informational texts that include a wide range of historical, cultural, ethnic, and global perspectives from a variety of genres.

4.3.R.6: Students will distinguish fact from opinion in an informational text and explain how reasons and facts support specific points.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This is a DOK 2 because the student must be able to recall what an opinion is and then apply that information to a set of sentences to determine which one meets that criteria.

Distractor Rationale

- A. This is a fact which can be measured.
- B. This is a fact that can be verified by the scientific study.
- C. This is a fact that can be verified by Barrett's study.
- D. **Correct.** This is an opinion about the Frankenstein inspiration Mary Shelley had from a dream.

5 In paragraph 2, the word theories means

- A** ideas.
- B** plans.
- C** pictures.
- D** questions.

Standard 4: Students will expand their grade-level vocabularies through reading, word study, and class discussion.

4.4.R.2: Students will use context clues to clarify the meaning of words.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2. The student draws meaning from surrounding text and makes a near inference to determine the meaning of the word.

Distractor Rationale

- A. Correct.** “Ideas” is correct because the word “theories” means systems of ideas intended to explain something.
- B.** The word “theories” means systems of ideas intended to explain something, not plans.
- C.** The word “theories” means systems of ideas intended to explain something, not pictures.
- D.** The word “theories” means systems of ideas intended to explain something, not questions.

6 An antonym for remember in paragraph 7 is

- A** enjoy.
- B** forget.
- C** create.
- D** describe.

Standard 4: Students will expand their grade-level vocabularies through reading, word study, and class discussion.

4.4.R.1: Students will identify relationships among words, including synonyms, antonyms, analogies, homophones, and homographs.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 1

This item is a DOK 1 because it requires very basic comprehension of the text and recall to respond.

Distractor Rationale

- A.** This is not the antonym for “remember” which means to recall.
- B. Correct.** This is the opposite for the word “remember” which means to recall.
- C.** This is not the antonym for “remember” which means to recall.
- D.** This is not the antonym for “remember” which means to recall.

7 Why are the section headings in bold print?

- A** to help the reader with new information
- B** to help the reader find important information quickly
- C** to help the reader understand the information better
- D** to help the reader remember the most important information

Standard 6: Students will gather, comprehend, evaluate, and synthesize researched information to acquire and refine knowledge.

4.6.R.2: Students will identify and use text features (e.g., graphics, captions, headings/subheadings, bold/italicized words, charts, tables, legends) to comprehend informational texts.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 1

This item is a DOK 1 because students must simply recall why headings are used in a text.

Distractor Rationale

- A. The section headings in bold print will not help the reader with new information presented.
- B. Correct. By looking at the topics of the section headings in bold print, the reader can locate particular information.**
- C. The section headings in bold print will not help the reader with understanding the new information presented.
- D. The section headings in bold print will not help the reader to remember the new information presented.

You will now read two related passages and answer the questions that follow. Some of these questions may ask you to compare the two passages.

The American Buffalo



- 1 The state animal of Oklahoma is the American buffalo. It is most closely related to the European bison and the Canadian woods bison. A bison is another name for a buffalo. A long time ago it could weigh as much as 5,000 pounds. But, over the years, the American buffalo has slimmed down. Today, it weighs from 800–2,000 pounds and stands about six feet tall. People recognize the American buffalo by the large size of its head and the high hump on its shoulders. It is also recognized by its thick, dark brown, shaggy hair. It is a very impressive animal.
- 2 The American buffalo came to North America from Asia. The animals crossed a land bridge that once connected Asia to Alaska. Before long, millions of buffalo freely roamed the prairies of America. The large herds of the American buffalo were part of the landscape. This was quite a beautiful sight.
- 3 Buffalo were an important part of Native American life as Native Americans could not survive without them. They hunted them for food and used their hides to create shelter and clothing. Native Americans made sure they used every part of the animal. They were not wasteful. But things changed when the settlers arrived.
- 4 Many of the settlers were trappers and traders. They began killing the American buffalo to sell. They would send the hides of the buffalo by train or wagon back east. These settlers did not have the same respect for the buffalo as the Native Americans. These settlers killed more than what they needed. Some settlers came to shoot the animals for sport. The situation for the American buffalo only got worse as time went on. There were fewer and fewer of them. Soon there were only a few thousand of the American buffalo left. They were on their way to becoming extinct.
- 5 Today, many people are working to help the American buffalo. They want to protect them. They want to see their numbers increase. There is a herd of buffalo in Yellowstone National Park. This herd is carefully protected. There are private groups who also want to preserve the American buffalo. Similar efforts will help guarantee the future of the American buffalo.

Read this passage, which goes with the previous passage. Then answer the questions that follow.

Seeing Buffalo

We went to the Bad Lands,
My family and me.
It was buffalo
We hoped to see.
5 We drove through the park
Until it was nearly dark.
Looking. Looking. Looking.
We came to the top of a hill
and stopped.
10 Our jaws dropped open,
And our eyes almost popped!
Buffalo filled the valley below.
It was the most amazing sight.
We stared in awe before
15 Finally saying good night.

8 Which sentence best summarizes paragraph 4 of “The American Buffalo”?

- A** Settlers sold buffalo hides for money.
- B** Settlers hunted the buffalo for entertainment.
- C** Settlers did not know how many buffalo there were, and they almost hunted the buffalo out of existence.
- D** Settlers did not value the buffalo in the same way others did, which almost caused the buffalo to die out.

Standard 2: Students will read and comprehend inclusive, diverse, and increasingly complex literary and informational texts.

4.2.R.4: Students will summarize facts and details from an informational text.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is labeled as DOK 2 because the student needs to not only have a deeper comprehension of the text than a DOK 1, but also because the student must draw meaning from the text, specifically paragraph 4, and determine which sentence best summarizes the important ideas in the paragraph.

Distractor Rationale

- A. This is just one detail presented in paragraph 4.
- B. This is just one detail presented in paragraph 4.
- C. This is not a detail presented in paragraph 4.
- D. **Correct.** This sentence summarizes the main ideas presented in paragraph 4.

Drag and drop **two** boxes into the table to show the features of informational text and poetry.

To drag a box, click and hold the box, and then drag it to the desired space. To change a box click and hold it, and then drag it back to the desired space.

it gives information that can be proven.

it has a beginning, middle, and end.

it has characters.

it tells a story.

it contains rhyme.

"The American Buffalo" is informational because	"Seeing Buffalo" is a poem because
it provides facts about the American buffalo.	
	it is organized using stanzas.

Standard 2: Students will read and comprehend inclusive, diverse, and increasingly complex literary and informational texts.

4.2.R.2: Students will compare fiction, poetry, and nonfiction to distinguish various genres.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student must understand the differences between genres and then apply that knowledge to the passage to determine its genre.

Distractor Rationale

"The American Buffalo" is informational because	"Seeing Buffalo" is a poem because
it provides facts about the American buffalo.	it contains rhyme.
it gives information that is true.	it is organized using stanzas.

10 Which sentence from “The American Buffalo” supports the statement “These settlers did not have the same respect for the buffalo as the Native Americans”?

- A** They want to protect them.
- B** This herd is carefully protected.
- C** Many of the settlers were trappers and traders.
- D** These settlers killed more than what they needed.

Standard 2: Students will read and comprehend inclusive, diverse, and increasingly complex literary and informational texts.

4.2.R.1: Students will determine the key details that support the main idea of a text.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student needs to perform mental processing that is more than simple recall. The student must comprehend what the culled sentence means and then determine which answer supports that idea.

Distractor Rationale

- A. Wanting to protect the buffalo does not support the idea of not having the same respect for the buffalo.
- B. Carefully protecting the herd does not support the idea of not having the same respect for the buffalo.
- C. The fact that many settlers were trappers and traders does not directly support the idea of not having the same respect for the buffalo.
- D. **Correct.** The idea of the settlers killing more buffalo than what was needed does support the idea of not having the same respect for the buffalo.

The information in a citation follows this order:
author, title, year of publication.

Drag the information into the boxes to show the correct order of the citation. To drag the information, click and hold the information, and then drag it to the desired space. To change the information, click and hold it, and then drag it back to the original location.

Chapter 3

Fowler, Ebonie

2022

Tulsa, OK

Little Eagle Publisher

"The Amazing Buffalo"

Standard 6: Students will engage in a recursive process that may include prewriting, drafting, revising, editing, and publishing.

4.6.W.2: Students will organize information found during research, following a modified citation style (i.e., author, title, publication year).

Depth-of-Knowledge: 1

This item is a DOK 1 because the student is completing the citation using scaffolding provided in the stem.

Distractor Rationale

The information in a citation follows this order:
author, title, year of publication.

Drag the information into the boxes to show the correct order of the citation. To drag the information, click and hold the information, and then drag it to the desired space. To change the information, click and hold it, and then drag it back to the original location.

Chapter 3

Fowler, Ebonie

"The Amazing Buffalo"

2022

Tulsa, OK

Little Eagle Publisher

12 The author of “The American Buffalo” most likely wrote this passage

- A** to inform the reader with details.
- B** to persuade the reader with facts.
- C** to entertain the reader with a story.
- D** to share a personal experience with the reader.

Standard 3: Students will analyze, interpret, and evaluate increasingly complex literary and informational texts that include a wide range of historical, cultural, ethnic, and global perspectives from a variety of genres.

4.3.R.1: Students will determine the author’s purpose (i.e., entertain, inform, persuade) by identifying key details.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 3

This sentence is a DOK 3 because the student must not only have a deep understanding of the text but also be able to go beyond the text and make inferences to come to an answer.

Distractor Rationale

- A. Correct.** This passage presents historical and modern day information about the American buffalo to the reader.
- B.** This passage presents historical and modern day facts about the American buffalo and is not trying to persuade the reader.
- C.** This passage presents historical and modern day facts about the American buffalo and is not entertaining the reader with a story.
- D.** This passage presents historical and modern day facts about the American buffalo and is not sharing a personal experience with the reader.

13 “The American Buffalo” is told from which point of view?

- A** first person by someone who works to help buffalo
- B** first person by someone who hunts buffalo
- C** third person by an unknown narrator
- D** third person by an unknown settler

Standard 3: Students will analyze, interpret, and evaluate increasingly complex literary and informational texts that include a wide range of historical, cultural, ethnic, and global perspectives from a variety of genres.

4.3.R.2: Students will determine whether a grade-level literary text is narrated in first- or third-person point of view.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This is a DOK 2. In this item, the student must recall what the different points of view are and apply that knowledge to determine the correct response to the question.

Distractor Rationale

- A.** The passage is not written in the first person.
- B.** The passage is not written in the first person.
- C. Correct.** The passage is written by an unknown narrator relating information as an outsider looking in and using the pronoun “they.”
- D.** The passage is not written in the third person by an unknown settler.

14 Describe how the author structures paragraphs 4 and 5 of “The American Buffalo.” Provide details from the passage to support your answer.

Standard 3: Students will analyze, interpret, and evaluate increasingly complex literary and informational texts that include a wide range of historical, cultural, ethnic, and global perspectives from a variety of genres.

4.3.R.7: Students will distinguish the structures of an informational text:

- cause/effect
- problem/solution
- description
- sequential

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This is a DOK 2 because the student is required to deeply understand the text, paragraphs 4 and 5 in particular. Then the student must be able to identify which structure is being applied and also be able to provide evidence that supports their response. The student communicates this through a written response rather than a choice response.

Correct Response:

Score	Description
2	The response fulfills the requirements of the task by describing how the author of “The American Buffalo” structures paragraphs 4 and 5. The details provided are based on the text and is relevant to the task.
1	The response fulfills some requirements of the task by describing or attempting to describe how the author of “The American Buffalo” structures paragraphs 4 and 5, but some of the supporting details may lack specificity or are not supported by the text.
0	The response does not fulfill the requirements of the task. The response is incorrect, irrelevant, or missing.
Blank	

Possible responses:

- The author of “The American Buffalo” uses problem and solution to structure paragraphs 4 and 5.

Possible supporting details:

- The author uses words and phrases to indicate a problem.
 - “These settlers killed more than what they needed.” (paragraph 4)
 - “Soon there were only a few thousand of the American buffalo left.” (paragraph 4)
 - “They were on their way to becoming extinct.” (paragraph 4)
- The author uses words and phrases to indicate people are working towards a solution.
 - “Today, many people are working to help the American buffalo.” (paragraph 5)
 - “There is a protected herd of buffalo in Yellowstone National Park.” (paragraph 5)
 - “There are private groups who also want to preserve the American buffalo.” (paragraph 5)
 - “Similar efforts will help guarantee the future of the American buffalo.” (paragraph 5)

Other responses are acceptable if supported by relevant details from the text.

15 Why did the attitudes about buffalo change?

- A** People realized that buffalo were going to disappear.
- B** People realized that buffalo were becoming too small.
- C** People realized that others depended on buffalo for survival.
- D** People realized that buffalo were not crossing the land bridge anymore.

Standard 3: Students will analyze, interpret, and evaluate increasingly complex literary and informational texts that include a wide range of historical, cultural, ethnic, and global perspectives from a variety of genres.

4.3.R.5: Students will answer inferential questions using evidence from one or more texts to support answers.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 3

This item is a DOK 3. The student must have a strong understanding of the passage and also go outside of the passage to make inferences to respond to the question.

Distractor Rationale

- A. Correct.** Once people realized that the American buffalo was becoming extinct, they began efforts that would preserve and protect the buffalo.
- B.** The weight of the buffalo has decreased from long ago, but the passage does not support the idea that that is why people changed their attitude about buffalo.
- C.** Although the passage indicates that Native Americans and early settlers depended on the buffalo for survival, the passage does not suggest that people continue to depend on buffalo for survival.
- D.** The land bridge no longer connects North America and Asia.

16 Which question would be best to use to find information about preserving the American buffalo?

- A** Where can the American buffalo be found besides Yellowstone National Park?
- B** When was the American buffalo selected as the state animal of Oklahoma?
- C** Why were laws passed to make it unlawful to hunt the American buffalo?
- D** What is the lifespan of the American buffalo?

Standard 6: Students will gather, comprehend, evaluate, and synthesize researched information to acquire and refine knowledge.

4.6.R.1: Students will conduct research to answer questions, including self-generated questions, and to build knowledge, using multiple sources (e.g., visual and text reference sources, electronic resources, and/or interviews).

Depth-of-Knowledge: 3

This item is a DOK 3. The student must have a strong understanding of the passage and also go beyond the passage to evaluate research questions related to the passage.

Distractor Rationale

- A.** This question would not lead to finding information about preserving the American buffalo.
- B.** This question would not lead to finding information about preserving the American buffalo.
- C. Correct.** This question would lead to finding information about preserving the American buffalo because it would help to find out about the laws that were enacted to help preserve the American buffalo.
- D.** This question would not lead to finding information about preserving the American buffalo.

17 Read the sentence.

The two trees leaves are turning brown.

What change, if any, should be made to trees in the sentence?

- A** tree's
- B** trees'
- C** treeses
- D** no change

Standard 5: Students will expand and apply knowledge of grammar, usage, mechanics, and style to speak and write effectively, demonstrating standard usage when appropriate.

4.5.W.6: Students will use apostrophes to show possession of singular and plural nouns and recognize and remove apostrophes used to form plurals.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student must be able to recall the rules regarding possessive plurals and also be able to apply them.

Distractor Rationale

- A. In the sentence "trees" is a plural noun and needs an apostrophe added after the "s" to make it a plural possessive noun.
- B. Correct. This shows that the leaves on multiple trees are turning brown.**
- C. This is the incorrect way to show the plural possessive of "trees."
- D. "Trees" is the plural form of tree, but it does not show possession.

18 Read the sentence.

My favorite relatives, uncle Juan and aunt Amalia, are coming for a visit.

Which words in the sentence should be capitalized?

- A** uncle, aunt
- B** favorite, relatives
- C** are, coming
- D** a, visit

Standard 5: Students will expand and apply knowledge of grammar, usage, mechanics, and style to speak and write effectively, demonstrating standard usage when appropriate.

4.5.W.4: Students will capitalize familial relations, proper adjectives, conventions of letter writing, and the first letter of a quotation.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student must be able to recall the rules regarding capitalization and also be able to apply them.

Distractor Rationale

- A. Correct.** The familial relationships “uncle” and “aunt” should be capitalized when used in front of their actual names.
- B.** “Favorite” is a common adjective, and “relatives” is a common noun.
- C.** “Are” and “coming” are the verbs in this sentence.
- D.** “A” is an article, and “visit” is a common noun.

19 Read the sentence.

I was surprised to see how much my cousin grows since I last saw him.

What change, if any, should be made to grows in the sentence?

- A** growing
- B** had grown
- C** will be growing
- D** no change

Standard 5: Students will expand and apply knowledge of grammar, usage, mechanics, and style to comprehend, analyze, and/or evaluate a variety of texts.

4.5.R.2: Students will recognize parts of speech in sentences:

- irregular possessive nouns (e.g., children's)
- irregular and past participle verbs and verb tense to identify settings, times, and sequences
- subject and verb agreement
- comparative and superlative adjectives
- prepositional phrases
- possessive pronouns and the nouns they replace (i.e., antecedents)
- coordinating conjunctions
- comparative and superlative adverbs
- interjections

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student must be able to recall the rules regarding subject-verb agreement and be able to apply them.

Distractor Rationale

- A. This is not a present perfect verb required by this sentence.
- B. Correct. This is the correct past perfect verb required by this sentence.**
- C. This is not a present perfect verb required by this sentence.
- D. This is not a present perfect verb required by this sentence.

20 Read the sentence.

I ran slowly than my friend.

What change, if any, should be made to slowly in the sentence?

- A** slower
- B** most slowly
- C** more slowly
- D** no change

Standard 5: Students will expand and apply knowledge of grammar, usage, mechanics, and style to comprehend, analyze, and/or evaluate a variety of texts.

4.5.R.2: Students will recognize parts of speech in sentences:

- irregular possessive nouns (e.g., children's)
- irregular and past participle verbs and verb tense to identify settings, times, and sequences
- subject and verb agreement
- comparative and superlative adjectives
- prepositional phrases
- possessive pronouns and the nouns they replace (i.e., antecedents)
- coordinating conjunctions
- comparative and superlative adverbs
- interjections

Depth-of-Knowledge: 1

This item is a DOK 1 because the student must follow the rules regarding adverbs.

Distractor Rationale

- A. This is not the correct comparative form for the adverb "slowly."
- B. This is the superlative form for the adverb "slowly," not the comparative form.
- C. Correct. This is the correct comparative form for the adverb "slowly."**
- D. This is not the correct comparative form for the adverb "slowly."

21 Read the sentences.

The class picnic is next Friday. I cannot go because of my brother's birthday party.

How can the sentences be rewritten as a compound sentence?

- A** The class picnic is next Friday, I cannot go because of my brother's birthday party.
- B** The class picnic is next Friday I cannot go because of my brother's birthday party.
- C** The class picnic is next Friday. And I cannot go because of my brother's birthday party.
- D** The class picnic is next Friday, but I cannot go because of my brother's birthday party.

Standard 5: Students will expand and apply knowledge of grammar, usage, mechanics, and style to speak and write effectively, demonstrating standard usage when appropriate.

4.5.W.1: Students will compose simple and compound declarative, interrogative, imperative, and exclamatory sentences, avoiding and correcting fragments.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student must be able to recall the different types of sentences and be able to apply the correct punctuation associated with them.

Distractor Rationale

- A. This is an example of a comma splice, which uses a comma to separate two independent clauses.
- B. This is an example of a run-on sentence which does not use a period to separate two independent clauses.
- C. This is an example of a sentence fragment with the word "And" used to begin the second independent clause.
- D. Correct. This sentence contains two independent clauses connected by the coordinating conjunction but and a comma.**

22 Read the sentence.

Bruce and Larry ride their bikes to school every day.

Which group of words in the sentence is a prepositional phrase?

- A** Bruce and Larry
- B** ride their bikes
- C** to school
- D** every day

Standard 5: Students will expand and apply knowledge of grammar, usage, mechanics, and style to comprehend, analyze, and/or evaluate a variety of texts.

4.5.R.2: Students will recognize parts of speech in sentences:

- irregular possessive nouns (e.g., children's)
- irregular and past participle verbs and verb tense to identify settings, times, and sequences
- subject and verb agreement
- comparative and superlative adjectives
- prepositional phrases
- possessive pronouns and the nouns they replace (i.e., antecedents)
- coordinating conjunctions
- comparative and superlative adverbs
- interjections

Depth-of-Knowledge: 1

This item is a DOK 1 because the student must only identify a prepositional phrase.

Distractor Rationale

- A. This is a compound noun.
- B. This is a verb phrase.
- C. Correct. This is a prepositional phrase using the preposition “to” followed by the noun “school.”**
- D. This is an adverb phrase.

23 Read the sentence.

The entire team, including the sisters, run during practice.

What change, if any, should be made to the sentence?

- A** The entire team, including the sisters, ran during practice.
- B** The entire team, including the sisters, runned during practice.
- C** The entire team, including the sisters, running during practice.
- D** no change

Standard 5: Students will expand and apply knowledge of grammar, usage, mechanics, and style to comprehend, analyze, and/or evaluate a variety of texts.

4.5.W.3: Students will recognize and correct errors in subject and verb agreement

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student must be able to recall the rules regarding subject-verb agreement and be able to apply them.

Distractor Rationale

- A. Correct.** “Team,” a collective noun, is the subject and takes a singular past tense verb in this sentence.
- B.** “Runned” is an incorrect past tense of the irregular verb “run.”
- C.** The sentence requires a past tense verb; “running” is the present progressive tense.
- D.** “Team,” a collective noun, is the subject and takes a singular past tense verb in this sentence.

Read this passage. Then answer the questions that follow.

Cracker Jack®

molasses—a thick brown syrup

- 1 Do you like a sweet treat? If so, then Cracker Jack® may be the thing for you. It is made with popcorn, molasses, and peanuts, and it is delicious. The fact that it has been around for over one hundred years proves that.

How It Began

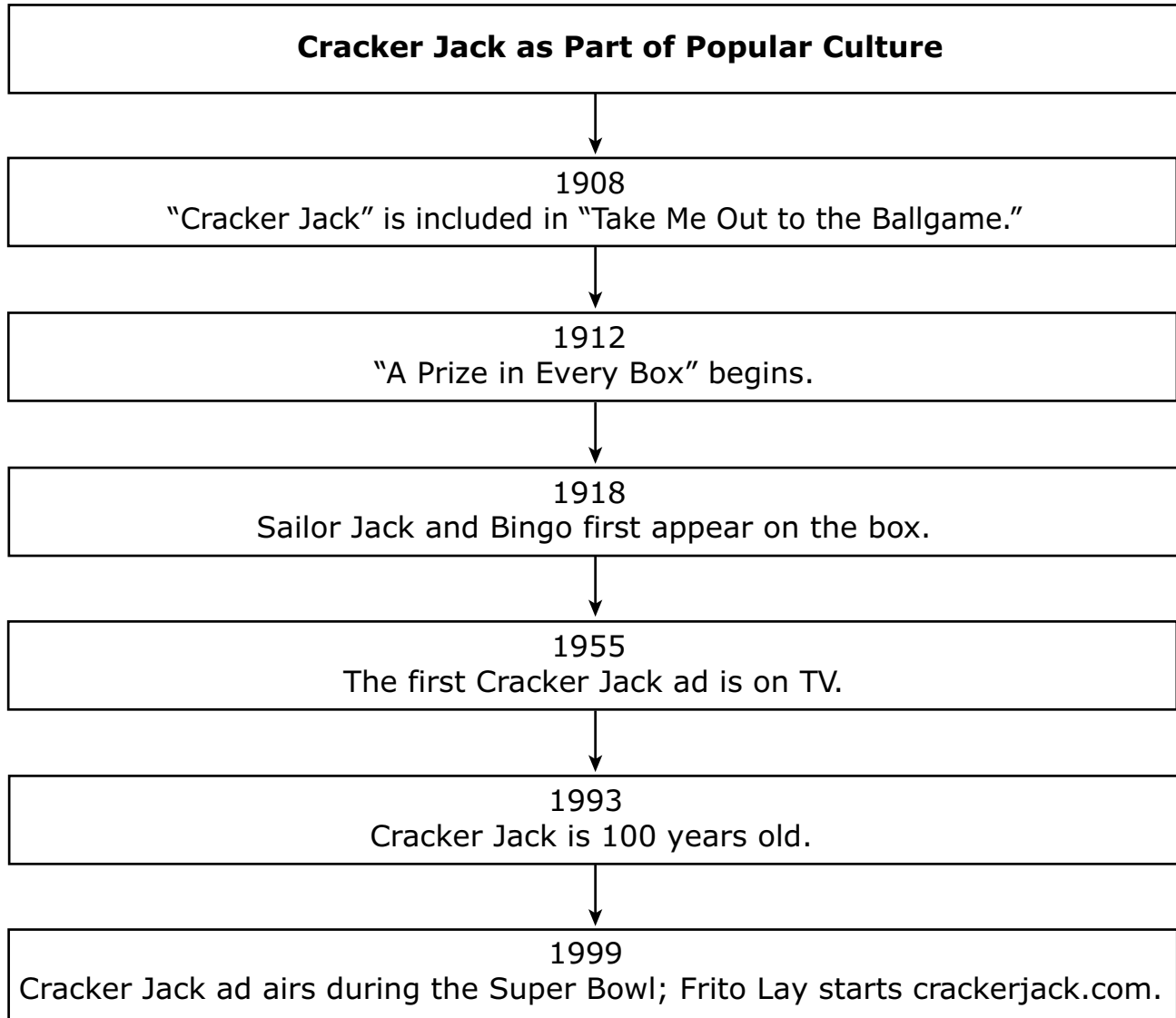
- 2 In 1872, Frederick Rueckheim left Germany and moved to Chicago. He began selling popcorn from a cart to earn money. In 1893, he and his brother Louis got an idea. They mixed popcorn, molasses, and peanuts to sell at the Chicago's World Fair. They called it Candied Popcorn and Peanuts. It was a big hit.
- 3 The brothers soon changed the name to Cracker Jack. The expression "cracker-jack" was used at that time to mean something that was very good. So this treat most likely got its new name because it tasted so good. Their slogan was "The more you eat, the more you want."
- 4 In 1908, the song "Take Me Out to the Ballgame" was written. It included the line "Buy me some peanuts and Cracker Jack." That helped make the snack a part of American culture.

The Package

- 5 There was one problem with the new treat—the mixture would stick together in chunks. So Louis made a formula for a great molasses coating that was crispy and dry. Soon after, Cracker Jack was no longer sold from large tubs. Instead, it was packaged in a wax-sealed box that kept moisture out.
- 6 Cracker Jack made their box with red, white, and blue stripes. They also put a boy named Sailor Jack on the box, along with his dog Bingo. These characters were based on Frederick's grandson and his dog.
- 7 In 1912, the company started putting a prize in every box. Over the years, billions of prizes have been given away. Children are often just as **excited** to find their prize as they are to eat the treat. Today, prizes have to meet safety guidelines, and they must also appeal to both boys and girls. Once a prize is selected, it takes about a year for it to make it into a box.

Recent Times

- 8 Cracker Jack still remains part of the American snack scene today. In addition, many fans of Cracker Jack belong to the Cracker Jack Association. There is also a Cracker Jack Box website. Fans now have a chance to share information about collecting old and new Cracker Jack prizes.



24 A reader can tell the passage is nonfiction because

- A** it is about real people and events.
- B** it has more than one character.
- C** it is written in short sentences.
- D** it takes place in the past.

Standard 2: Students will read and comprehend inclusive, diverse, and increasingly complex literary and informational texts.

4.2.R.2: Students will compare fiction, poetry, and nonfiction to distinguish various genres.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student must understand the differences between genres and then apply that knowledge to the passage to determine its genre.

Distractor Rationale

- A. **Correct.** A key feature of nonfiction texts is that they share information about people and places who really exist now or have existed in the past.
- B. The number of characters is not a defining feature of nonfiction texts. Nonfiction and fiction texts can have multiple characters.
- C. Short sentences can be in both fiction and nonfiction texts.
- D. Fiction and nonfiction texts can take place in the past.

25 The reader can tell that Cracker Jack

- A** is mainly eaten at sporting events.
- B** has changed its coating many times.
- C** is the most common snack food today.
- D** has been enjoyed for many generations.

Standard 3: Students will analyze, interpret, and evaluate increasingly complex literary and informational texts that include a wide range of historical, cultural, ethnic, and global perspectives from a variety of genres.

4.3.R.5: Students will answer inferential questions using evidence from one or more texts to support answers.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student uses the information contained in the passage to make an inference.

Distractor Rationale

- A. There is nothing in the passage to suggest that Cracker Jack is mainly eaten at sporting events. Paragraph 4 states that Cracker Jack was mentioned in a song about baseball, but there are no other references to sports in the passage.
- B. Paragraphs 2 and 5 show that the molasses coating has only been changed twice.
- C. This information is not supported by the passage. Paragraph 8 indicates that it is still “part of the snack scene,” but no facts are provided to prove that it is the most common snack food.
- D. **Correct.** Paragraph 1 notes that Cracker Jack was first invented in 1893, and that it was “a big hit.” In 1908, the mention of Cracker Jack in the song “Take Me Out to the Ballgame” made the treat even more popular. Finally, paragraph 8 states that “Cracker Jack still remains part of the American snack scene today,” which supports the idea that it has been enjoyed for many generations.

26 Why did the brothers **most likely** choose the name Cracker Jack?

- A** They had a relative named Jack.
- B** They thought children would like it.
- C** They knew it meant something that is very good.
- D** They thought Candied Popcorn and Peanuts was too long.

Standard 3: Students will analyze, interpret, and evaluate increasingly complex literary and informational texts that include a wide range of historical, cultural, ethnic, and global perspectives from a variety of genres.

4.3.R.5: Students will answer inferential questions using evidence from one or more texts to support answers.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student uses the information contained in the passage to make an inference.

Distractor Rationale

- A. Paragraph 3 states that at the time Cracker Jack was invented, “cracker-jack” meant something very good. The name Cracker Jack was used to show that the treat itself was very good. In paragraph 6 it notes that the characters used to represent the treat were *based on* the inventor’s grandson, not that they were named after him or any other relative.
- B. While it is probable that the term “cracker-jack” was a popular with children, it is not supported in the passage that children would like a snack named after a popular saying.
- C. **Correct.** “Cracker-jack” meant something very good, and the treat itself was very good. This information is supported by the details in paragraph 3.
- D. While “Candied Popcorn and Peanuts” is a long name, nothing in the passage suggests that anyone thought the name was too long. Rather, they wanted a name that conveyed how tasty the treat was.

- 27** Which sentence from the passage contains an **opinion**?
- A** It is made with popcorn, molasses, and peanuts, and it is delicious.
 - B** Cracker Jack made their box with red, white, and blue stripes.
 - C** These characters were based on Frederick’s grandson and his dog.
 - D** Once a prize is selected, it takes about a year for it to make it into a box.

Standard 3: Students will analyze, interpret, and evaluate increasingly complex literary and informational texts that include a wide range of historical, cultural, ethnic, and global perspectives from a variety of genres.

4.3.R.6: Students will distinguish fact from opinion in an informational text and explain how reasons and facts support specific points.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student must first know what an opinion and then apply that knowledge to a set of statements in order to select the correct response.

Distractor Rationale

- A. Correct. The first clause contains a fact—the ingredients can be verified. However, not all people will agree that the snack is delicious; it is not information that can be proven.**
- B.** This sentence is a fact. It can be proven by looking at boxes of Cracker Jack.
- C.** This sentence is a fact. It can be confirmed by looking at other sources.
- D.** This information can be verified by calling the company, so it is a fact.

28 Which word is a synonym for **excited** as used in paragraph 7?

- A** thrilled
- B** curious
- C** grateful
- D** contented

Standard 4: Students will expand their grade-level vocabularies through reading, word study, and class discussion.

4.4.R.1: Students will identify relationships among words, including synonyms, antonyms, analogies, homophones, and homographs.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student must know the definition of a specific word and then identify a different word with a similar meaning.

Distractor Rationale

- A. Correct.** Words that have the same or similar meanings are called “synonyms.” The words “excited” and “thrilled” both mean “extremely pleased.”
- B.** “Curious” relates to one’s attitude towards learning something new. Being excited is not the same as being curious.
- C.** “Grateful” means to be appreciative of “benefits received.” It has a different meaning than “excited.”
- D.** “Contented” means to be satisfied with something. It suggests a calm manner. “Excited” suggests the opposite.

29 Read these sentences from paragraph 2.

They called it Candied Popcorn and Peanuts. It was a big hit.

How could these sentences be rewritten as a compound sentence?

- A** They called it Candied Popcorn and Peanuts, and it was a big hit.
- B** They called it Candied Popcorn and Peanuts and it was a big hit.
- C** They called it Candied Popcorn and Peanuts it was a big hit.
- D** They called it Candied Popcorn and Peanuts, it was a big hit.

Standard 5: Students will expand and apply knowledge of grammar, usage, mechanics, and style to speak and write effectively, demonstrating standard usage when appropriate.

4.5.W.1: Students will compose simple and compound declarative, interrogative, imperative, and exclamatory sentences, avoiding and correcting fragments.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student needs to understand what a compound sentence is and then apply that knowledge to create a compound sentence.

Distractor Rationale

- A. Correct.** A compound sentence consists of two independent clauses joined by a comma and a coordinating conjunction that shows the relationship between them.
- B.** Although a coordinating conjunction has been included, it is missing the comma preceding the coordinating conjunction.
- C.** This is a run-on sentence. Two independent clauses have been put together as a single clause.
- D.** A comma has been used to join the two clauses, but it is missing a coordinating conjunction.

